

Science: Plants and Microhabitats

Aims (as taken from the Science: Whole-School Progression Map) Identify and name a variety of plants and animals in their habitats, including microhabitats. Using their observations and ideas to suggest answers to questions. To explore plants as microhabitats.		Lesson Duration All timings are approximate. 75 mins
Success Criteria I can define 'microhabitat'. I can name plants that minibeasts use for shelter. I can use an identification sheet.	Key Vocabulary Words in <i>italics</i> are polysemous words. Words in bold are defined in the Knowledge Organiser . Tier 1 (everyday words) <i>plant</i> Tier 2 (words that are important in different science topics) minibeast , identify, identification sheet, habitat, microhabitat , <i>shelter</i> , magnifying glass, tally chart Tier 3 (words that are specific to this science topic)	
Standard School Equipment Clipboards Pencils Magnifying glasses Electronic devices with a free plant identification app installed (optional)	Preparation Plant Identification Sheet – as required Level Up Perfect Plants Activity Sheet – as required Optional Resources Knowledge Organiser – as required Mighty Minibeasts eBook Pages (provided on electronic devices or as printouts) – as required Reasoning Card 3: Plants and Microhabitats – as required Biodiversity – Minibeasts Learning Journey – as required	
Accessibility Suggestions • Prior to the lesson, carry out a risk assessment and make adaptations so the main activity is accessible to all. • Offer the option to complete this lesson's activities with adult support, where available, to suit the needs of your learners. • Consider recording learning through alternative means such as teacher observation, video recordings or talking tins. • Provide a copy of the Plants and Microhabitats Word Mat and consider using the Plants and Microhabitats Vocabulary Picture Cards to pre-teach vocabulary. • You may wish to use the dyslexic font alternative resources provided within this lesson pack. For more information on using different fonts with dyslexic learners, see the Dyslexia Fonts Guidance and Identifying the Right Font Tool pack. The Medium-Term Plan offers further advice for addressing the four main areas of need: communication and interaction; cognition and learning; social, emotional, and mental health (SEMH); and sensory and physical needs.		

Prior and Future Learning Children may have practised using tally charts in year 2 maths. Children may have studied habitats and microhabitats in the year 2 Living Things and Their Habitats unit. Children have explored minibeasts' basic need for shelter in lesson 1 of this unit. Please refer to the [Science: Whole-School Progression Map](#) for prior learning and progression.

Be Mind Kind: While every care has been taken to ensure that there are no significant emotional triggers regarding eco-anxiety for learners in this lesson, any feelings that arise should be embraced and discussed non-judgementally.

Outdoor Learning: This resource is provided for informational and educational purposes only. As this resource refers to outdoor learning, you must ensure that an adequate risk assessment is carried out prior to using this resource. You must contact a suitably qualified professional if you are unsure. Twinkl is not responsible for the health and safety of your group or environment. Outdoor areas provide great opportunities for playing and learning, but you should always check any environmental risks before taking part in outdoor activities, and only proceed if it is safe to do so. For example, even the shallowest amount of water can be extremely dangerous. You should ensure that learners wash their hands after being outside, and are respectful of nature, taking care of animals and plants. Please be aware that learners should be supervised at all times, particularly young or vulnerable learners.

Touching or Working with Plants: As this resource refers to plants, you must ensure that an adequate risk assessment is carried out prior to using this resource. It is your responsibility to ensure you are aware of the allergies and health conditions of anyone touching or working with plants. Twinkl is not responsible for the health and safety of your group or environment. It is your responsibility to ensure the resource and the information/activity it contains are safe and appropriate to use in your situation.



Learning Sequence

	Remember It: Study the minibeasts shown on the Lesson Presentation and sort them into two groups based on the basic need for shelter.	5 mins
	Key Vocabulary: Refer to the Lesson Presentation to highlight the key vocabulary for the lesson. Note that the words in bold are those shown on the Knowledge Organiser and will have definitions.	5 mins
	What's a Habitat? Revisit the definition of a habitat. Explore a woodland habitat and identify the places where a minibeast might live within it.	5 mins
	Microhabitats? Define 'microhabitat'. Support the children to spot the microhabitats in the woodland scene. Can the children define 'microhabitat'?	5 mins
	Green Houses: Explain that plants can be microhabitats for minibeasts. Direct the children to follow the lines on the Lesson Presentation to discover some examples of plant microhabitats. Can the children name some plants that minibeasts use for shelter?	5 mins
	Being a Nature Spotter: Explore how identification sheets are used to help to name living things using the Mighty Minibeasts eBook . Practise using an identification sheet on the Lesson Presentation to name a plant. Can the children explain what identification sheets are used for?	10 mins
	Zooming In: Explain what a magnifying glass is and how to properly use one. You may wish to provide magnifying glasses so the children can practise using them.	5 mins
	Taking a Tally: Revisit how to record findings using a tally chart. Check the children can interpret the tally chart shown on the Lesson Presentation .	5 mins
	Spotting Plant Microhabitats: Explore the grounds of your educational setting with the children. Using the Plant Identification Sheet , ask the children to record how many minibeasts they find on the plants outside on their tally chart. Can the children name the plants they see that minibeasts are using for shelter?	20 mins
	Charge Up: Support the children to identify plants by using a free plant identification app.	
	Level Up: Ask the children to reason why the plants they find make good microhabitats for minibeasts. Children could use the word bank on the Level Up Perfect Plants Activity Sheet to support their explanations.	
	A Wonderful World: Define biodiversity as the different (variety of) plants and animals in a habitat. Consider the biodiversity of plants and minibeasts in the local area and what changes could be made to attract more minibeasts to the area.	5 mins
	STEM/Green Careers: Explore the career of a horticulturist and how their knowledge of plants can help to make gardens suitable for minibeasts.	5 mins

Additional Learning Opportunities

Reasoning Cards

Using [Reasoning Card 3: Plants and Microhabitats](#), children will study a completed tally chart and explain the findings it shows.

More to Explore

- Children could play the [Minibeast Microhabitats Scratch and Reveal Game](#).
- Children could display their results in a physical block diagram.
- Children could draw the plants in their educational setting.

Assessment

Scientific Knowledge

Working Towards the Expected Level

With support, children can name plants in their setting that are microhabitats for minibeasts.

Children:

Working At the Expected Level

Children can identify and name plants in their setting that are microhabitats for minibeasts.

Children:

Working At Greater Depth

Children can confidently identify and name plants in their setting that are microhabitats for minibeasts and explain why they are suitable shelters.

Children:

Working Scientifically

Working Towards the Expected Level

With support, children can observe and name living things. Children may use a magnifying glass to support their observations.

Children:

Working At the Expected Level

Children can use their observations and an identification sheet to name living things. Children may use a magnifying glass to make their observations accurately.

Children:

Working At Greater Depth

Children can use their observations and confidently use an identification sheet to name living things and justify their answers. Children may use a magnifying glass to make their observations accurately.

Children: